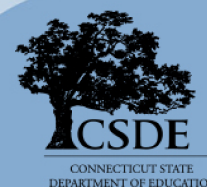


DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020–21



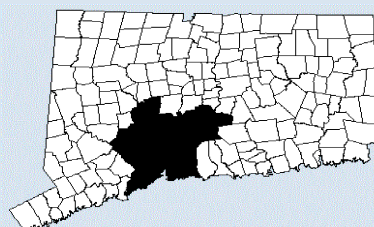
Area Cooperative Educational Services

Dr. Thomas Danehy, Superintendent • 203-498-6817 • www.aces.org

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	11
Enrollment	1,826
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$36,894
Total Expenditures ¹	\$78,843,053

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.



Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2020 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	765	41.9	48.4
Male	1,061	58.1	51.5
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	65	3.6	5.2
Black or African American	556	30.4	12.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	688	37.7	27.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	94	5.1	4.0
White	412	22.6	49.9
English Learners	146	8.0	8.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,078	59.0	42.7
Students with Disabilities ³	776	42.5	16.3

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed (*) when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	348	45.7	20	2.5
Male	594	56.5	69	6.2
Black or African American	297	53.4	49	8.4
Hispanic or Latino of any race	404	59.0	21	3.0
White	171	42.3	13	3.0
English Learners	84	58.7	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	674	61.1	63	5.4
Students with Disabilities	472	60.4	56	6.7
District	942	52.0	89	4.7
State		19.0		1.4

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: 200

Number of school-based arrests: Fewer than 6

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Area Cooperative Educational Services

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	108.5
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	20.9
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	95.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	307.2
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	7.6
School Level	16.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	3.0
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	18.5
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	30.0
School Nurses	13.1
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	176.0

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	3	1.0	1.3
Black or African American	16	5.6	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	13	4.5	4.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.1
White	256	88.9	89.9

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	7.3	7.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	16	64.0	14	35.9
Hispanic or Latino of any race	0	*	12	30.8
White	6	30.0	*	*
English Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	22	61.1	28	33.7
Students with Disabilities	28	47.5	34	25.6
District	28	47.5	34	25.6
State		75.9		85.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual enrollment courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A
Emotional Disturbance	N/A	N/A
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A
District	N/A	N/A
State		67.9

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Area Cooperative Educational Services

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A	2.1
Emotional Disturbance	N/A	N/A	1.1
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A	0.5
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A	5.8
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A	3.3
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A	1.9
All Disabilities	N/A	N/A	15.9

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	N/A	N/A	8.3
Private Schools or Other Settings	N/A	N/A	4.8

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2019-20

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$50,224,419	\$23,502	\$11,205
Support services - students	\$6,787,731	\$3,176	\$1,346
Support services - instruction	\$1,484,243	\$695	\$698
Support services - general administration	\$3,787,887	\$1,773	\$464
Support services - school based administration	\$2,666,615	\$1,248	\$1,037
Central and other support services	\$3,272,998	\$1,532	\$691
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$6,010,828	\$2,813	\$1,692
Student transportation services	\$4,608,333	\$2,410	\$1,159
Food services	.	.	\$21
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$151
Total	\$78,843,053	\$36,894	\$17,838

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$9,407,185	20.6	29.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$7,219,231	15.8	11.1
Other Salaries	\$14,648,594	32.1	9.5
Employee Benefits	\$9,452,491	20.7	13.5
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$1,104,333	2.4	5.4
Special Education Tuition	.	.	22.5
Supplies	\$1,048,299	2.3	0.5
Property Services	\$1,696,596	3.7	0.3
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$432,629	0.9	7.2
Equipment	\$636,898	1.4	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$19,392	0.0	0.1
Total	\$45,665,649	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		57.9	25.1

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2019-20

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	79.8
State	19.6
Federal	0.6
Tuition & Other	0.0

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Area Cooperative Educational Services

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

READING	NAEP 2019		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	40	41	50
National Public	34	32	36
MATH	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	45	39	32
National Public	40	33	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Area Cooperative Educational Services

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2019-20	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	N/A	N/A
Hispanic or Latino of any race	N/A	N/A
English Learners	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	N/A	N/A
Students with Disabilities	N/A	N/A
District	N/A	N/A
State		88.8

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2019-20 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Meeting Benchmark on at Least One College Readiness Exam³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	17.8	0	0.0
Male	29.3	*	*
Black or African American	39.1	0	0.0
Hispanic or Latino	14.9	*	*
White	18.5	0	0.0
English Learners	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	29.4	*	*
Students with Disabilities	26.6	*	*
District	26.6	*	*
State	85.0		36.0

³ College readiness exams and benchmark scores are as follows:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam

⁴ Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2021 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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* The data are suppressed to ensure confidentiality.

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2020	Class of 2019
	Entrance ³	Persistence ⁴
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	*	*
Male	*	*
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	*	*
English Learners	*	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	*	*
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	*	*
State	67.4	84.9

³ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁴ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Area Cooperative Educational Services

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	State Average Index/Rate
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	52.0%	<=5%	19.0%
	High Needs Students	58.2%	<=5%	30.2%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	32.3%	75%	80.6%
	% Passing Exams	0.5%	75%	36.0%
On-track to High School Graduation		77.5%	94%	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)		.	94%	88.8%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort)		.	94%	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)		.	75%	67.4%
Arts Access		10.8%	60%	50.7%

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Graduation Rate Gap	.	.	.	.	.

¹ If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

² If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf

Detailed Presentation at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Area Cooperative Educational Services

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Area Cooperative Educational Services (ACES) is the Regional Educational Service Center in south central Connecticut that is dedicated to enhancing and transforming lives through education, innovation, and leadership. Our vision is to create an equitable and socially just world, one life at a time by engaging the community through Open and Magnet School Parent Choice programs and Minority Teacher Recruitment initiatives.

We offer behavior services for individuals on the autism spectrum, occupational physical therapy, professional development, and technology services. Initiatives that focus on developing community relationships provides transition opportunities for students from our high school program to gain experience in the area of office supports at local churches while developing community experience by volunteering as local animal shelters. The Integrated Preschool program offers an active, supportive learning environment in which special needs children and typical peers learn together through developmentally appropriate theme-based activities and experiences. The curriculum is based on the Preschool Common Core State Standards as well as the Connecticut Early Learning and Development Standards. Schools also assess and provide training around pre-vocational and community skills for students. Mentoring programs and after school clubs or activities for students with autism facilitate social skills and leisure skills. Staff participate in various trainings in the area of trauma informed interventions focused on relationships, safety, therapeutic interventions and coping skills in order to support students facing various mental health challenges. Ongoing trainings focus on addressing reading difficulties that impact the academic setting. Technology engages students in the development of academic and social skills as students utilize Smartboards to show their skills in the area of broadcasting and reporting.

Truancy impacts all populations and ages. Staff engage families through phone calls, emails and parent meetings to offer support in getting students to schools. Schools utilize various strategies that include the development of committees to review data to determine trends and patterns and make recommendation on ways to proactively engage families and students.

Family engagement activities promotes collaboration by participating in school based committees such as the Parent Teacher Coalition to plan and implement activities such as student presentations of Project Based Learning projects, Open House, creation of a Facebook page, parent trainings for students on the spectrum and IEP development and implementation, Game Night, Harvest Festival and Prom . These activities as well as the Family Barbecue and Trunk or Treat allow students to generalize skills such as turn taking while increasing communication skills. ACES has developed a technology training program for parents in an effort to support families in working at home with their children during periods of virtual or distance instruction.

Collaborative programs continued to support the integration of special needs students with typical peers in their home school. The high school program at West Haven affords expanded opportunities for inclusion and integration with typical peers.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

As a Regional Educational Service Center, ACES works together with our 25 member school districts to reduce academic and social issues stemming from racial, ethnic, and economic isolation. To successfully achieve our mission, ACES operates 3 interdistrict magnet schools enrolling over 1600 students, coordinates several interdistrict collaborative programs, and facilitates Open Choice for our districts.

ACES magnet schools are designed to attract students across many school districts increasing educational opportunities for students of diverse backgrounds to learn along side one another. Each school reinforces its mission of diversity while delivering a high quality curriculum with unique academic focus. Technology allows students to access their learning through multiple resources and has been said to be a great divide for student learning. We provide state of the art technology support and services for all of our students in order to assist students in their learning in person and remotely. Most of our schools offer their students a one-to-one laptop/iPad experience. We are working with local universities to develop laboratory classrooms to support action research in our schools and to support the development of teacher cohorts for our member school districts. Our magnet schools have also had the opportunity to participate along with other school districts in the interdistrict grant partnerships. Here, our schools' teachers and students work along with fellow schools from other districts. We seek out opportunities to partner for technology, math, social studies, science and L/A enrichment.

ACES has been instrumental in Minority Teacher Recruitment (MTR) efforts in CT. The MTR Advisory Council has developed and implemented strategies to increase the number of minority educators, including our highly successful annual MTR Job Fair. As a member of the RESC MTR Alliance, ACES played a key role in securing funding from the State Pipeline, ACES now operates a teacher Residency Program that is aimed at attracting and retaining teachers of color.

ACES has a agency-wide Diversity Committee and has hired a Director of Diversity, Equity and Inclusion to provide DEI leadership across the agency.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Area Cooperative Educational Services

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

ACES is the Regional Educational Service Center for twenty-five school districts in south central Connecticut. Each local school district appoints a representative to the ACES Governing Board of Education. Our Board works collectively to set a strategic direction for our organization based on the educational needs of the region and our school system. ACES operates schools and programs based on these needs, and the Governing Board ensures the equitable allocation of resources among the programs. Each of our full-time interdistrict Magnet Schools has a steering committee which monitors and approves resource allocations in its respective program.

Local funding, State of Connecticut magnet school support, and grant resources are utilized to achieve and enhance equity among our programs. Building level principals and directors meet monthly with ACES Central Administration to discuss issues relating to available resources in meeting their academic goals. This process also assists the district and agency plan for budget development. The budget process includes a committee, the building administrator(s), ACES Central Administration, and the ACES Governing Board.